

Isaiah 53:5 But he was pierced for our transgressions, he was crushed for our iniquities; the punishment that brought us peace was on him, and by his wounds we are healed.

Definition of *guilt*

1: the fact of having committed a breach of conduct especially violating law and involving a penalty - *A jury will determine the defendant's **guilt** or innocence. broadly : guilty conduct*

2 a: the state of one who has committed an offense especially consciously *His **guilt** was written in his face.*

b: feelings of deserving blame especially for imagined offenses or from a sense of inadequacy : **SELF-REPROACH**

3: a feeling of deserving blame for offenses - *Wracked by **guilt**, he confessed his affairs.*

Definition of *shame* (Entry 1 of 2)

1 a : a painful emotion caused by consciousness of guilt, shortcoming, or impropriety

b: the susceptibility to such emotion - *have you no **shame**?*

2: a condition of humiliating disgrace or disrepute : **IGNOMINY** -*the **shame** of being arrested*

3 a: something that brings censure or reproach *also : something to be regretted : **PITY** -it's a **shame** you can't go*

b : a cause of feeling shame

The opposite of guilt is - innocence, virtue, blameless, guiltlessness, satisfaction, honor, respect, sinlessness

The opposite of Shame is - honor, a steam, respect, glory, regard, praise

What is the difference between guilt and shame?

Well, **guilt has to do with our conduct**. Guilt is a fact or statement of wrongdoing. It's a state of being. Guilt implies one has committed an offense, violated a law, or are convicted of doing something wrong. Guilt is being responsible for having done something wrong. Guilt may include feelings of remorse for having acted incorrectly – sort of a heartfelt wish you had done something different or were not responsible for the actions or consequences of those actions. Guilt tempts us to shift blame. Guilt requires repayment, restitution.

Guilt involves feeling bad about something regardless of whether anyone knows.

Shame, however, is a painful feeling of being dirty, tainted, humiliated, somehow less worthy because of your guilt or the guilt of someone else. Shame is that feeling of being exposed, *really seen* with all the wrongness clinging to you. It carries a sense of being dishonorable, unacceptable, disgraceful, foolish, unlovable, and unworthy. Shame tempts us to hide. Shame requires cleansing, removal of the stain.

Shame involves a deep rooted fear that someone's going to find out what you've done and judge you harshly.

Consequently, Shame might cause you to lie and destroy any evidence that you messed up because you are desperate to preserve your reputation..

Scientists can see the difference in the brain when they examine people who experience guilt versus shame. In MRIs, shame sets off high activity in the right area of the brain, but not in the amygdala. Guilt activates the amygdala in the frontal lobe which ultimately means that shame is a much more complex emotion.

Keep in mind that **guilt can be healthy**. If you feel guilty that you yelled at someone, for example, you might make an effort to keep your cool next time. **Shame isn't healthy**. However, it causes us to hide things and it reinforces unhealthy beliefs about ourselves like I'm not good enough. That leads us to believe that we just aren't capable of doing any better. So rather than think I made a bad choice or something bad happened to me. You'll believe I'm a bad person, but we often confuse the two.

Brenea Brown is an expert on shame. She is a shame researcher and written several best selling books. She says **shame needs three things to grow exponentially in our lives. Secrecy, silence and judgment**. As for the **antidote to shame, she says shame cannot survive being spoken, it cannot survive empathy**. So what does that mean? The first step in overcoming shame is doing what likely scares you the most, telling someone about whatever it is that you feel shame about. Opening up to someone who is empathetic will automatically reduce the amount of shame you feel. But that means you need to be careful about who you pick to share your story with.

If it feels too scary to tell someone you might start by writing your story in a journal. Just getting your story out of your head and onto a page might help you experience a little less shame and it might give you the courage you need to share your story with someone who can listen with empathy. So that's the best way to reframe your shame. Tell someone about the shame you feel and why you feel it. Bringing it to light can reduce your suffering.

Shame says 2 things... You are never good enough.... Who do you think you are

Vulnerability is our MOST accurate measurement of Courage

Guilt & Shame in the garden, Adam and Eve were *guilty* of violating God's instruction, and deserved the penalty of death because of their *guilt*. Then Adam blamed Eve and God ("**the woman**" – **blaming her**, "**you gave me**" – **blaming God**) to avoid responsibility for his guilt. Eve blamed the serpent ("**the serpent deceived me**" – **blame shifting**).

When God entered the garden on the day they committed their offense, they hid because they were *ashamed*. Before they were guilty, they were naked and *unashamed*, and there was no need to hide.

And on that day God declared their guilt, clarified their death sentence, and promised a Savior who would settle their guilt-debt (Genesis 3:14-15). *He also provided covering for their shame* (Genesis 3:21).

Hebrews 12:2 - *looking unto Jesus the author and finisher of our faith; who for the joy that was set before him endured the cross, despising the shame, and is set down at the right hand of the throne of God.*

Christian quotes about guilt & shame

"The conscience is a built-in warning system that signals us when something we have done is wrong. The conscience is to our souls what pain sensors are to our bodies: it inflicts distress, in the form of guilt, whenever we violate what our hearts tell us is right." John MacArthur

"The way to no longer feel guilty is not to deny guilt, but to face it and ask for God's forgiveness."

“When he says we’re forgiven, let’s unload the guilt. When he says we’re valuable, let’s believe him. . . . When he says we’re provided for, let’s stop worrying. God’s efforts are strongest when our efforts are useless.” Max Lucado

“Guilt says, “You failed.” Shame says, “You’re a failure.” Grace says, “Your failures are forgiven.” – Lecrae.

Psalm 32:1-5 *Happy is the person whose sins are forgiven, whose wrongs are pardoned. Happy is the person whom the Lord does not consider guilty and in whom there is nothing false. When I kept things to myself, I felt weak deep inside me. I moaned all day long. Day and night you punished me. My strength was gone as in the summer heat. Then I confessed my sins to you and didn’t hide my guilt. I said, “I will confess my sins to the Lord,” and you forgave my guilt.*

Sometimes we feel guilty over our past sins.

Isaiah 43:25 *“I, I am the one who blots out your transgression for my own sake, and I’ll remember your sins no more.*

Romans 8:1 *Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus.*

Guilt leads to repentance.

2 Corinthians 7:9-10 *Now I rejoice, not because you were grieved, but because your grief led to repentance. For you were grieved as God willed, so that you didn’t experience any loss from us. For godly grief produces a repentance not to be regretted and leading to salvation, but worldly grief produces death.*

Put the past behind you and move forward.

2 Corinthians 5:17 *So then, if anyone is in Christ, he is a **new** creation; what is old has passed away—look, what is new has come!*

Philippians 3:13-14 *Brothers and sisters, I do not consider myself to have attained this. Instead I am single-minded: Forgetting the things that are behind and reaching out for the things that are ahead, with this goal in mind, I strive toward the prize of the upward call of God in Christ Jesus.*

So Now What?

Hebrews 10:22 *let us go right into the presence of God with sincere hearts fully trusting him. For our guilty consciences have been sprinkled with Christ's blood to make us clean, and our bodies have been washed with pure water.*

Hebrews 12:2 - *looking unto Jesus the author and finisher of our faith; who for the joy that was set before him endured the cross, despising the shame, and is set down at the right hand of the throne of God.*

Shane Merrill - Overcomers Meeting 10/20/22